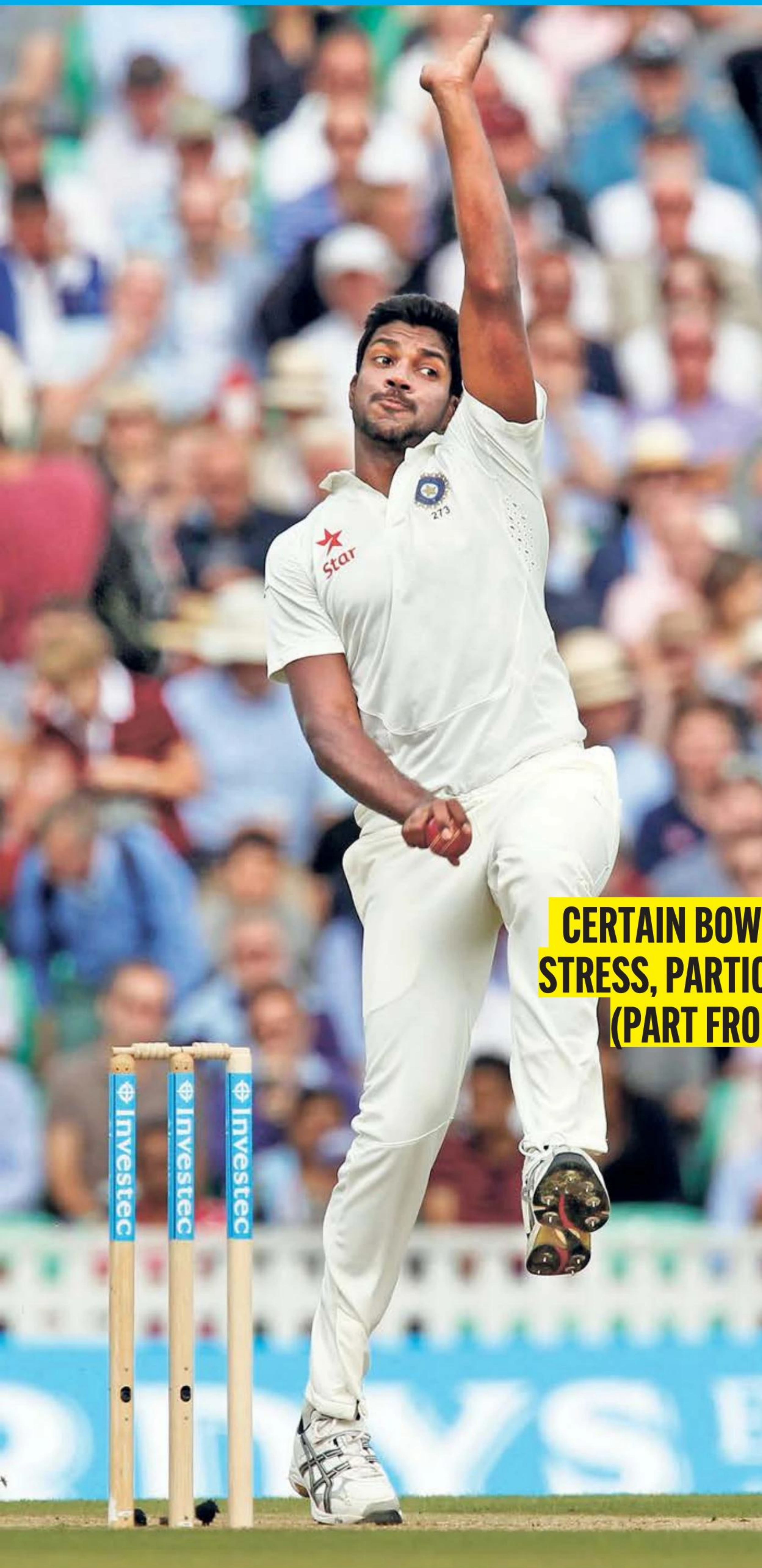




Pace like fire: In a country starved of genuine pace, Varun Aaron stood out in the early 2010s, regularly clocking over 145 kmph. But recurring back injuries — the price of bowling fast — cut his career short. AFP

the transition without a buffer. And vice versa.” When players arrive for the two-month high-intensity tournament, the team management already has data about each individual, tracking everything from workload to fitness.

“Throughout the year, we collect insights through relationships with respective boards, handovers, GPS data, and nutrition reports. When bowlers arrive, we already have a clear picture,” Gloster says. “If a player is fatigued or not sleeping properly, that’s a risk. While we don’t control their training year-round, we use the data we have to tailor management plans during the IPL,” he adds.

Gloster believes that bowlers are often blamed when they break down while bowling, but the problem often starts in other areas of their training. “Poor gym training – lifting incorrectly or lifting too heavy – also

CERTAIN BOWLING ACTIONS INCREASE STRESS, PARTICULARLY MIXED ACTIONS (PART FRONT-ON, PART SIDEWAYS)

contributes. When assessing workload, we must consider both bowling and gym activities.”

“For fast bowlers, the focus should be on building a strong, responsive posterior chain and legs, maintaining core stability, and preserving mobility – not just adding muscle mass. When spinal loading is poorly managed in the gym, it adds to the cumulative stress on the body and can tip the balance toward injury,” Leipus opines.

The teams screen each player on